



SITA RAM GUPTA'S VISION FOR A SAMRIDDH BHARAT

You have companies that do good work with their CSR budgets. And then you have Sita Ram Gupta, having implemented some path breaking ideas that are redefining CSR, he has a vision for a prosperous India and a road map for it.

While a prosperous, self sufficient India is a hope that all of us cherish, Sita Ram Gupta is a man who has rolled up his sleeves to make it a reality. He is working with a well fleshed out plan that has succeeded in providing a ray of hope to people who had given up.

Sita Ram Gupta has mapped India into 748 districts. Roughly 203 districts are poor in terms of overall development. NITI Aayog has selected 115 for transformation under Aspirational District Program. The remaining 88 need to be adopted by CSOs, CSR Agencies or respective states for development.

Gupta recommends that we focus on Empowerment Line instead of Poverty Line framework, to drive India's progress. He believes that the answer lies in creating sustainable livelihoods for rural and economically challenged communities. Some of the key interventions that Gupta suggests are :

Agriculture for boosting High Income: The introduction of improved high value crops, improved varieties of seeds and infusion of technologies for enhancing the incomes are essential. Switching to natural farming, high value crops, vegetables, horticulture and medicinal plants should deliver better results. Support in the form of gradation, processing & storage will help value creation. Farmer's Producers Organization's can create a conducive environment for farmers.

Animal Husbandry to be boosted for High Income: Diversification of income sources are required to cope up with climate change issue. Along with the agriculture, promotion of dairy animals, goat & poultry units should be promoted.

Water Resource Development – for Advancement of Agriculture and Animal Husbandry: To increase the agriculture production, additional areas under irrigation needs to increase. Rainwater harvesting and construction of check dams for arresting the runoff water are important. Water bodies like ponds, percolation tanks, check-dams in the villages, need to be rejuvenated.

Unemployment And Skill Development – Should Be The Thrust Areas: To reach global employment rate standards, India needs to employ an additional 20 Crores people. Job creation in India is possible only if we focus on Skill development. Skill development training in India should be made compulsory to enhance all-round expertise of the people. More importance should be given to self-employment in the villages. Thus will ensure that citizens do not migrate in search of jobs.

Health – Time to Fix It Now: The quality of services by PHCs & CHCs needs



to be improved by strengthening infrastructure facilities, technology infusion, introduction of telemedicine service and deployment of trained manpower.

Nutrition – Waging A War Against Malnutrition: Over 33.23 lakhs children in India are undernourished. We can combat it with nutritious foods, medicinal plants and kitchen gardens, besides boosting immunity.

The mid-day meal can be bolstered with fruits, honey & egg, sourced from local farmers.

Education – Building Human Capital A Must Now: The new education policy will transform India's education system by increasing the learning level. The Education sector assumes importance as poverty in India is expected to increase from 55% to 70% due to school closure during the pandemic.

Environment & Climate Change – The Biggest Challenge Of The Era: Climate Change affects the economic growth and development of a Nation. The government should promote Small and Medium Enterprises and Cottage industries as they are environment friendly and demonstrate how a low carbon economy can come into existence.

Inequality: According to World Inequality Report (2022) - the top 10% of the Indian population earns 57% of the national income. The share of the bottom 50% in national income has declined to 13%. By ensuring universal access to public funded high quality services like Public health and education, social security benefits, employment guarantee schemes, inequality can be reduced to a great extent.

Utilization of Unutilized/Under-Utilized Human Resources: Using the unemployed youth to man the most important services will help.

Adoption of Poor Districts For Holistic Development: One District–Corporate/PSU/big NGO engagement strategy is required to be adopted for fast-track development of the poor districts.

To make gram panchayats Atma Nirbhar, the transparency should be the first step in this endeavour. The display of flagship schemes digitally through village information Center can achieve this goal.

Gupta has chalked out the programs & the approaches needed to enable an inclusive growth that will enable us to achieve the target of building USD 5 trillion economy by 2024-25 or by 2025-26. His end aim is to increase per capita income so as to foster inclusive growth leading to India evolving as a happy nation.

